Committee: Special Political and Decolonization Committee (SPECPOL)

Topic: Tackling the Impacts of Neocolonialism on Developing Nations

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Introduction

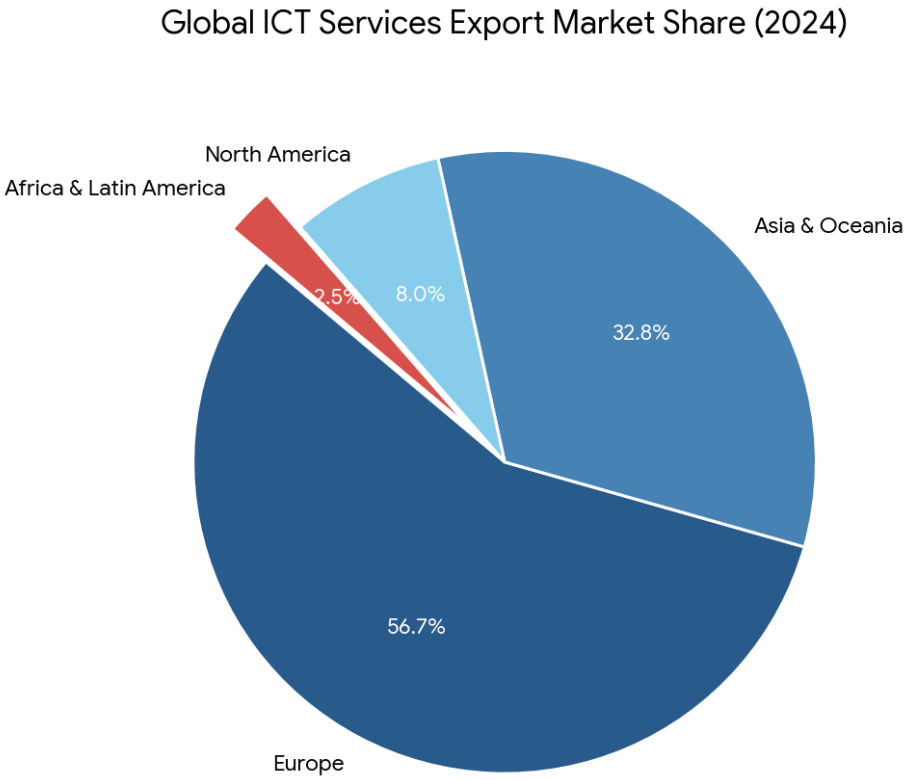
After World War II had ended, mainly due to the decline of imperialist powers resulting from victory of the United Nations, most of the colonies achieved independence, leading to the official termination of traditional colonialism. However, in a different context with colonial independence, formerly colonized nations found it difficult to completely break free from the economic and cultural influence of their past colonizers as the aftermath of colonial rule. This is one of the most widely recognized forms of neocolonialism, with notable examples including France–Nigeria, United States–Philippines, and Belgium–the Democratic Republic of the Congo.

Although neocolonialism has an inseparable relationship with colonialism, it does not always emerge as a consequence of colonialism. Like China–Sri Lanka, neocolonialism can involve economic compulsion, such as providing large scale loans or aids. Or it can derive from geopolitical and military relations through military assistance or security cooperation, United States–Iraq, for instance. Recently, the activities of the United States' global platform companies and China's digital silk road have been interpreted as forms of neocolonialism. This leads the exercise of cultural and informational influence through media, platforms, and technical standards to be viewed as a type of neocolonialism.

As previously mentioned, neocolonialism most commonly manifests through approaches by powerful nations involving economic methods or cultural influence. To be specific, controls over natural resources, debt dependency, an economy centered on multinational corporations, and financial systems are the most common types of economic intervention. While economic neocolonialism is often driven by policies intentionally designed by nations or corporations, cultural neocolonialism has

tended to expand more naturally following the intensification of cultural diffusion in modern society. These kinds of cultural impacts include language, education, media, and lifestyle.

Neocolonialism is frequently confused with globalization, yet it differs from globalization in that it clearly entails issues of social concern. Neocolonialism is a modern-day challenge being intensively addressed by the UN, as it drives the generation of one-sided benefits based on power imbalances which is a dynamic that can give rise to serious issues in international relations within the realms of cultural diplomacy and international exchange.



International trade in ICT services (UNCTAD, 2024)

This graph illustrates the growing importance of international trade in information and communication technology (ICT) services. It relates to digital neocolonialism by highlighting how unequal access to digital infrastructure and technology may reinforce the dependence of developing nations on technologically advanced countries.

Definition of Key Terms

Colonialism

Colonialism refers to the practice of a people extending and maintaining control over other regions and their inhabitants. As it involves inhumane practices that diverge from modern ethics, its origin is traced differently, depending on perspectives. Sometimes the origin is considered ancient Egypt or the Roman Empire, while at other times the Spanish Empire of the mid-to-late 15th century is viewed as the starting point. Subsequently, around the 19th century, this evolved into imperialism, wherein major powers employed military, political, and economic means to dominate other nations or regions and expand their territories and influence. Because of this historical context, neocolonialism mostly originated from imperialistic colonialism.

Neocolonialism

Neocolonialism is the use of economic, political, cultural, or sometimes military pressures by developed nations and multinational corporations to control or influence developing countries, particularly former colonies, without formal political rule. Neocolonialism is a relatively modern concept, and because there is no clear criterion for distinguishing between asymmetrical, dependent relationships and standard diplomatic relations, there is a wide range of opinion regarding how the term should be defined.

Postcolonialism

Focusing on regions that were subjected to colonial rule in the contemporary era, there have been a series of ideological and literary movements emerging in an effort to break free from political conditions such as colonialism and imperialism, which is known as postcolonialism. As postcolonialism criticizes colonial legacy in order to overcome it, postcolonialism connotes the fact that the aftermath of colonialism continues to exert a profound influence on formerly colonized nations. However, today it is being used as a crucial framework for critically analyzing the power relations inherent in modern society, such as racism, gender issues, and the inequalities arising from globalization.

Neoliberalism

Neoliberalism is an economic and political ideology advocating for the minimization of government intervention and the maximization of free market competition and autonomy. Alongside the trend of globalization, it has established itself as a core tenet of modern capitalism. Whereas it seems justifiable for a market economy, neoliberalism is viewed by some scholars as a potential instrument of modern-day neocolonialism, through which major powers and global capital may influence the economic policy choices of developing nations, not via military force, but usually through market logic and economic dominance.

Multinational Corporation (MNC)

When a company produces and sells goods or services on a global scale, maintaining subsidiaries, factories, or branch offices in at least two countries, it is called a multinational corporation, or company. Economic penetration by multinational corporations (MNCs) is sometimes deliberate. For instance, the provision of financial bailouts to developing nations is frequently conditioned on allowing MNCs easy access to local markets. Consequently, the outflow of profits may contribute to economic dependency and limit the economic policy autonomy of developing countries.

Debt Trap

Debt Trap, which has a similar context with multinational corporations, is a prime instrument of neocolonial domination, involving lending vast sums of money to impoverished nations, amounts impossible to repay, and then using that debt as a pretext to seize the nations' assets or political sovereignty. When developing nations struggle with heavy debt and face the risk of default, their rights to operate major ports, their territories, or their mineral extraction rights are legally seized in exchange for debt forgiveness. Multinational corporations (MNCs) are frequently implicated in this process. While neocolonialism manifests in various forms and contexts, bailouts triggered by debt traps serve as a mechanism through which economic dependence can deepen.

Cultural Hegemony

In a situation where distinct disparities in authority and power exist, the extent of a nation's cultural dissemination and the level of preference it commands are also shaped by its capital and technological capabilities. This phenomenon is known as cultural hegemony. Although it seems natural and rightful following the flow of globalization, what actually causes a problem is the fact that the culture of developed nations begins to gain popularity, as it gradually comes to dominate local life and establish itself as the global standard. This leads to a situation where, beyond mere cultural consumption, even one's way of thinking shifts to align with the frameworks of developed nations, perhaps resulting in the disappearance or weakening of domestic culture. The key feature of cultural hegemony is that this influence does not necessarily come through direct intimidation. Instead, the dominant culture becomes accepted as natural, modern, or universal, causing people to adopt its values and ways of thinking voluntarily.

Interculturalism

Interculturalism is the key paradigm adopted by international organizations, such as the European Union (EU) and UNESCO, to address the conflicts of modern multicultural societies and counter cultural hegemony. Unlike cultural hegemony, in which the culture of one side spreads unilaterally and exerts influence, interculturalism seeks to prevent cultural imbalance by emphasizing the value of mutual cultural exchange. A prime example of the activities championed by UNESCO is the Convention on the Protection and Promotion of the Diversity of Cultural Expressions. It legally regulates cultural monopolies held by major powers and ensures that cultural content from ethnic minorities and developing nations is protected and exchanged on the international stage.

The Logic of Power

The logic of power refers to the idea that states, especially powerful ones, seek to protect and expand their own interests by using their available resources and influence. These resources can include military power, economic assistance, political influence, and diplomatic pressure. In the context of neocolonialism, powerful countries use these forms of power to influence weaker or developing countries without directly controlling or colonizing them. For example, they may support a friendly government, provide economic aid in exchange for political influence, or maintain military bases in another country. Thus, the logic of power helps explain how powerful states can maintain influence even after formal colonial rule has ended.

Background Information

Historical Background

In 1945, when World War II officially came to an end, the imperial powers lost their ability to maintain the colonization as a result of the profound political, economic, and geopolitical changes following the war. Most countries that had been under colonial rule gained political independence, and the long-entrenched imperialist international order appeared to be changing. However, in 1944, toward the end of World War II, the global economic system was restructured through the adoption of a gold-convertibility system and the establishment of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD). This followed the Bretton Woods Conference held in the United States. As only 44 nations attended the conference, a foundation wasn't laid for nations under colonial rule to achieve economic independence.

The idea of neocolonialism caused a sensation internationally in 1965, after 9 years of its first introduction, in the book "Neo-Colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism" by former Ghanaian President Kwame Nkrumah. At that time, despite Ghana's independence from England, Ghana operated under British banks and indirect credit control. Not only Ghana, but other countries like Brazil and Vietnam were also facing roundabout interference by resource monopoly, propaganda, and so on. As it was a very adroit method of sovereign control, only the leaders and authorities were aware of the strategies of the great power. Nevertheless, they could not openly resist, as they encountered pressure from the great power and practical difficulties in reforming their economic capital. Seizing that opportunity, a new form of influence with colonial characteristics spread rapidly.

Since the 1970s, because of continuous looting and the absence of a proprietary economy, even the nations that are politically independent have needed external aid. Ultimately, the countries had to borrow funds from Western-led financial institutions such as the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank, which were the result of the Bretton Woods Conference. Although it seemed the organizations were essential for the newly independent nations to arrange their own economic system, it made some nations subordinate to other countries' economic systems. It is considered the origin of neocolonialism in that it marked the beginning of the legal domination of a nation's sovereignty and economy. While this specific form largely disappeared today, it persists in various other ways.

Structural Characteristics

The most crucial element of neocolonialism is indirectness, as has constantly been mentioned. Because the characteristics of neocolonialism manifest in numerous aspects, it is difficult to summarize them specifically, but they are most prominent in the realms of economies and cultures. Foreign powers exert influence over domestic politics by using economic control as a key instrument of domination. Or they would attempt to dominate even general perceptions and ideologies through culture, which includes education, media, religion, and propaganda.

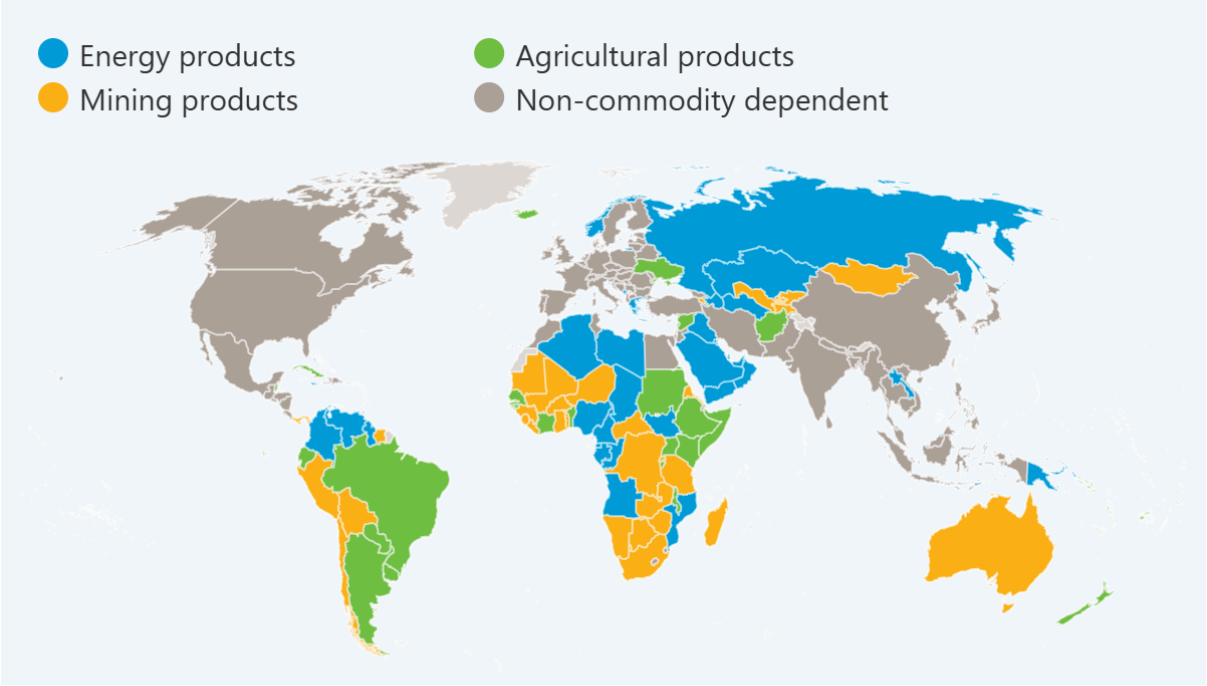
In some cases, the major powers might maintain their influence through violent methods, such as military power bases, but still in hands-off ways. In terms of military interference, the point is not to instigate conflict by actually using military force, but rather to pressure and demonstrate that power to the international community. Another typical one is support for domestic antigovernment forces. They would intervene in civil wars by providing support such as mercenaries or proxy forces to bolster factions favorable to their own interests, or by attempting to weaken a government's power by backing military coups to install a pro-friendly regime.

Mechanisms of Control

The key factor of neocolonialism is the subordinate dynamic. In this relationship, a nation becomes unable to make autonomous economic or political decisions because it relies heavily on a more powerful nation or external institutions. The dependent nation struggles to achieve self-reliance due to an industrial structure that relies solely on resource exports, or a dependence on technology, capital, and the market. If dependency persists, a nation remains nominally independent but sees its actual freedom of choice diminished, thereby exacerbating the issues associated with that dependency. Even without a direct command of the dominant nation, the international economy or the policy itself exacts a specific choice.

What invariably follows the flow of a dependent structure is an asymmetrical power relation. As the structure simply shows, if a certain state acts as a dominant one which affects the other to change policies and make choices to inevitably subordinate to them, the dominant state can exert significant power over the other state. In this situation, imbalance manifests not only in law or politics but also in bargaining power. Neocolonialism, on the surface, the progression, which contains negotiation, contract, aid, investment, and then diplomacy, appears to be a relationship between

equals. In reality, however, one side possesses multiple options while the other has almost none. Consequently, even when negotiations take place, the outcome may not be justified.



Commodity dependence by dominant export product group (UNCTAD, 2025)

This graph shows the extent to which countries depend on a dominant commodity export group, illustrating the vulnerability of economies reliant on raw material exports. Such dependence may reinforce economic neocolonialism by limiting industrial diversification and increasing developing nations' exposure to external market forces.

Another particular mechanism is known as elite collaboration, which Nkrumah also especially highlights in his book. After the neocolonial relationship is created by external influence, it is maintained with the balance of power between the dominant state and the interests of local political and economic elites. In other words, domination does not originate solely from the outside but is mediated through the domestic power elites. The configuration emerged in neocolonialism because direct rule by a foreign government would draw criticism from the international community. So instead, it is far more efficient to maintain the local government and exercise influence through it.

Possible solutions

Reinforcing International Norms For Multinational Corporations

As Multinational Corporations (MNC) take a huge role in neocolonialism, regulating in order to prevent MNCs from using loopholes to slip through within the legal framework is arguably the most realistic approach. For example, in case of MNCs monopolizing mining development rights, employing workers at low wages, or evading taxes in developing countries, it has been receiving criticism that while it may be legally permissible, it could ultimately reinforce a structure of economic dependency for developing countries. The United Nations, alongside the International Labour Organization (ILO) and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), has been discussing it as a response to the international community to address this particular issue.

More specifically, the reinforced norms require an obligation to protect human rights such as prohibition of forced labor or child labor, or the guarantee of labor rights. It is an indisputable fact that these kinds of human rights-related responsibilities already exist in international laws. Yet intergovernmental organizations face limitations because they often rely on soft laws. These provide recommendations for companies and governments rather than legally binding obligations or enforceable penalties. Furthermore, since it is often difficult to assign actual responsibility due to the complexity of determining which country's laws apply, whether the headquarters bears responsibility, or whether only the subcontractor is responsible, strengthening the legal framework is a necessity. In recent years, the European Union (EU) has acted as a pioneer for this trend. Issued by the EU, the Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD) is a law that requests a certain scale of corporations to investigate and respond to human rights and environmental risks throughout the supply chain. Another one is the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD) enacted by the EU as well, demanding large corporations meeting certain criteria to provide information in terms of sustainability.

As much as human rights protection, environmental protection is also an area where multinational corporations tread a fine line. Deforestation, water or soil pollution actually occurs in the process of resource investment and extraction. Therefore, holding accountability for the results needs to be added in the international norms. Like human rights protection directly being offered in a law state, environmental protection is addressed by supply chain environmental due diligence, requiring self-conducted assessments to prevent or minimize environmental damage.

Improvement of International Debt Restructuring and Debt Relief Mechanisms

The idea of improved debt restructuring and debt relief mechanisms is not about unconditional debt forgiveness, but about preventing developing countries from losing economic sovereignty due to excessive debt. As formerly presented, a number of developing countries take out a loan mostly because of economic crisis, or infrastructure expansion. But what actually makes a future obstacle is when the governmental budget is used for repayment of principal and interest, but not for social welfare. Then a nation won't be able to implement independent economic policies or invest in new industries.

So what the financial institutions like the World Bank and International Monetary Fund (IMF) are trying to shift is the debt repayment terms. Specific measures such as extending the repayment period, lowering interest rates, and deferring repayments are currently being discussed to offer developing nations time to recover their economic borrowings. Another method that is under discussion is to allow debt relief in order to ease the debt burden. This goes a step further in debt restructuring as it includes partial debt forgiveness, interest reduction, or even partial principal waiver. But this contains concerns such as moral hazards, thus it usually goes together with conditions like economic reform or increased transparency. Also, even when issuing a new loan, assessing whether a country has the actual capacity to repay and to prevent the accumulation of excessive debt, in other words, to establish sustainable financing from the outset, are preferable to relying on debt forgiveness after loans have been issued.

These days, with various creditors, such as the IMF, the World Bank, the Paris Club, private creditors, and bilateral creditors like China, often negotiating separately, the process tends to be prolonged, and differing terms among creditors can make resolution difficult. Deliberations are underway to improve this and establish a more consistent and transparent structure in which all major creditors participate. The IMF and the World Bank are working together with the G20, operating the Global Sovereign Debt Roundtable (GSDR) to enhance the debt restructuring process. In April 2026, they announced the Restructuring Playbook, providing specific guidelines on the order and procedures for negotiations to be followed by countries facing a debt crisis.

Strengthening International Tax Systems and Cooperation

In neocolonialism, MNCs can obtain huge amounts of profits using a dependent nation's resources, but issues arise when profits are shifted to tax haven, where taxes are exempted or subject to very low tax rates like the Cayman Islands or Luxembourg, or tax liabilities are minimized by exploiting differences in tax rates between countries, resulting in dependent country governments failing to receive adequate tax revenue. In this situation, the dependent nations cannot receive a reasonable amount of tax refund, leading to inability to secure funding for their domestic education, public health, and infrastructure.

The international community is promoting 3 major solutions, which are global minimum tax, Base Erosion and Profit Shifting (BEPS), and tax information exchange. The global minimum tax is a policy under which the OECD and G20 reached an agreement to require MNCs within its scope to pay a minimum effective corporate tax rate of 15%. It is part of Pillar Two of the OECD/G20 BEPS Project. This aims to avoid competition between nations to cut corporate taxes and to decrease tax haven usage, while reducing the incentive for MNCs to shift profits to countries with lower tax rates. Likewise, the BEPS Project is an international initiative that addresses the shifting of profits to other countries via manipulation of transfer pricing, royalty payments, or intercompany loans. It includes measures to improve transparency, such as requiring multinational corporations to report financial information to tax authorities. While the previous methods both address the tax haven problem, tax information exchange exists to handle tax evasion. By nations sharing taxation information, they get to identify overseas accounts, subsidiaries, and ultimate beneficial owners.

The UN is currently working on the UN Framework Convention on International Tax Cooperation, intended for ensuring that developing countries actively participate in setting international tax rules and creating a fairer international tax system. This is a move toward improvement to address criticisms that the views of developing countries are not sufficiently reflected in the existing OECD-centered tax system.

Strengthening Local Cultural Industries Through Targeted Support

Cultural neocolonialism is influenced by various factors, such as globalization, making it realistically difficult to prevent or resolve. However, regardless of such cultural exchanges and trends, the harm caused by cultural neocolonialism can be mitigated not by blocking the influx of foreign cultures, but by focusing on the preservation of one's own culture. Given that large-scale foreign cultural industries and platforms dominate the domestic cultural market, the most prominent approach is for governments and public institutions to provide targeted support in key areas, enabling individual nations to foster the growth of their own cultural industries.

There are three main ways to implement this, and the most common of which is providing financial support to local creators and small businesses. This includes grants or low-interest loans to independent filmmakers, local publishers, musicians, and traditional craftspeople to help them secure production cost and equipment. These kinds of financial policies can mitigate the issue of local content failing to enter the market due to a lack of funding. While this carries multifaceted significance, such as the revitalization of local economies, beyond merely representing a form of cultural neocolonialism, it could also impose a financial burden on the state. Another case is expanding the distribution of regional language and cultural content. This involves supporting the translation, distribution, and promotion of books, films, and music in regional languages so that they can reach audiences both domestically and internationally. The goal of this activity is to secure opportunities for exposure to diverse cultures within an environment where, currently, only content from large overseas corporations is easily accessible. Yet, the cooperation of local publishers or production companies is required, and the effectiveness may vary depending on their influence. Lastly, strengthening digital production and distribution capabilities could also be one approach. This provides local creators with digital production skills, training in online distribution, promotional support, and opportunities to enter overseas markets. This increases the possibility of securing an audience without relying entirely on global platforms for content distribution. However, the effectiveness of policies can vary significantly from country to country, depending on the size of their respective domestic digital markets.

Limiting or preventing opportunities to encounter and adopt the cultures of other nations can, in fact, become a cause of cultural neocolonialism. Therefore, the key to addressing cultural neocolonialism lies not in blocking foreign cultures, but in creating an environment where a nation's own culture can compete in the international market and continue to evolve.

Major parties involved

French Republic - Federal Republic of Nigeria

France and Nigeria is a representative case of neocolonialism stemming from support for domestic antigovernment forces. During the Nigerian Civil War, the Nigerian federal government fought against the separatist forces of Biafra in the country's eastern region. France provided military support to Biafra, specifically involving the supply of weapons and ammunition. France emerged as a primary military backer of Biafra. Analyses suggest that one of its objectives was to curb Nigeria's growing regional influence in Africa. Although France did not directly rule Nigeria, its actions can be seen as an instance of neocolonial intervention, as it exerted influence over the political situation of another nation by supporting a faction that aligned with its own interests.

United States of America - Republic of the Philippines

Even after gaining independence from the United States in 1946, the Philippines allowed the United States to utilize military bases within its territory under the 1947 Military Bases Agreement. It enabled the U.S. to maintain and project military power across the Western Pacific and Asia. United States diplomatic documents from the era confirm that these bases played a crucial role not only in the defense of the Philippines but also in broader U.S. strategy for the Asian region. It is particularly significant that the Philippines was officially an independent nation. While the United States did not recolonize the country, the long-term presence of American military bases on Philippines soil allowed the United States to retain substantial military influence.

Kingdom of Belgium - Democratic Republic of the Congo

A real-world example of economic neocolonialism is a multinational corporation and the Democratic Republic of the Congo. The global high-tech industry relies heavily on the Democratic Republic of the Congo, as the country produces 70% of the world's cobalt, which is a mineral essential for electric vehicle batteries, smartphones, and laptops. Since mine development requires massive capital, foreign companies often secure mining rights rather than local firms; multinational corporations, starting with Belgian ones, began to take the lead in operating cobalt mines in the

Congo. As economic neocolonialism driven by multinational corporations impacts the Congo, issues such as a low-value-added industrial structure, the outflow of mining profits overseas, and labor exploitation have emerged.

United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland - Republic of India

The United Kingdom and India serve as examples of cultural neocolonialism that continues to exert influence to this day. During the period of British colonial rule in India (1858-1947), English became the primary language of administration and education. Although India subsequently gained independence, English continued to be widely used in administration and education, while Hindi is the official language of the Union. English also continues to be used for official purposes under the Official Languages Act of 1963. Moreover, India's legal system remains based on British common law, consequently making the operation of courts, the reliance on judicial precedents, and the legal profession have all been influenced by British systems. Eventually, issues such as cultural dependency and the weakening of indigenous languages emerged as a problem of cultural neocolonialism.

People's Republic of China - Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka

Relations between China and Sri Lanka are frequently cited as an example of expanding influence through economic investment and infrastructure projects. China provided substantial funding for the construction of Sri Lanka’s Hambantota Port. Subsequently, as Sri Lanka faced financial difficulties, it leased the port’s operational rights to a Chinese state-owned enterprise for 99 years. Consequently, China is viewed as having expanded its strategic and economic influence over Sri Lanka through such support and investment. However, as there is academic debate regarding the debt trap diplomacy, it is more accurate to avoid drawing such a definitive conclusion.

Timeline Of Events

Date	Description of Event
Bretton Woods Conference, July 1944	Established the IMF and World Bank, shaping the postwar global financial system.
End of World War II, September 1945	Accelerated decolonization and the decline of colonial empires.
Bandung Conference, April 1955	United Asian and African nations against colonialism.
UNGA Resolution 1514, December 1960	Marked the international commitment to ending colonial rule.
「*Neo-Colonialism: The Last Stage of Imperialism*」*published, October 1965*	Nkrumah defined and brought out the concept of neocolonialism.
Structural Adjustment Programs Expanded, 1983	IMF loans increasingly required privatization and market reforms.
Washington Consensus, 1989	Formalized key neoliberal policy recommendations for developing countries.
World Trade Organization Established, January 1995	Expanded the global rules for free trade and market liberalization.
UNESCO Convention, October 2005	Protected cultural diversity and promoted intercultural exchange.
Addis Ababa Action Agenda, July 2015	Discussed how to mobilize the financial resources needed to eradicate poverty.
Mondiacult World Conference on Cultural Policies, September 2022	Recognized culture not merely as artistic activity, but as a public good for sustainable development.
Global Digital Compact Adopted, September 2024	Adopted to reduce the digital divide between countries.

UN Involvement, Resolutions, Treaties and Events

- Declaration on the Granting of Independence to Colonial Countries and Peoples, 14 December 1960 (1514)

  This declaration is evaluated as a foundation for political decolonization, recognizing the right of self-determination of all nations and states. It paradoxically showed that even though almost all of the colonies achieved independence, they couldn't get rid of imperial powers' technologies and economies. Thus, the issue was raised that political independence alone does not constitute true independence, and it is interpreted that this sparked the debate on neocolonialism.

- Declaration on the Establishment of a New International Economic Order, 1 May 1974 (3201)

  In the mid 1960s, decolonized undeveloped nations faced persistent poverty. They realized that the poverty attributed from such problems including prices determined by developed nations, or exporting only raw materials. There, the G77, the largest consultative body of developing countries within the UN, requested a new economic order, which then became a basis of a New International Economic Order (NIEO). This resolution specifically emphasized the permanent sovereignty of natural resources, and expanded participation in international economic decision-making.

- Financing for Development Conference (FfD)

  This series of conferences is an international development finance conference hosted by the UN. It was held on four occasions, in 2002, 2008, 2015 and 2025, and consistently addressed the agendas of expanding development finance, resolving debt issues, and improving the international financial system. In 2015, the 3rd conference which is called the Addis Ababa Action Agenda, mobilizing the financial resources to achieve SDGs has become a key agenda item.

- General Assembly resolution 1803 (XVII), 14 December 1962

  This resolution declares the principle that a nation and its people have the right to control their own natural resources and to utilize those resources for their own development and the well-being of their population. This resolution was treated as a set of principles supporting the decolonization and economic independence of nations, in line with the prevailing trends during the era when colonized states were gaining their independence. The resolution's main principles include permanent sovereignty, control over foreign investment, nationalization and compensation.

- Charter of Economic Rights and Duties of States, 12 December 1974

  In a similar context to General Assembly resolution 1803, the charter emerged to address the issue that political independence alone did not guarantee economic self-reliance for nations that gained their independence during the 1960s and 1970s. It played a crucial role in securing the economic decision-making authority of these newly independent states, encompassing areas such as economic sovereignty, nationalization, and the transfer of property.

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